

**PROGRAM SUITABLE FOR ALL
COMBAT SPORTS**

THE BOXING FOUNDATION



**FUNDAMENTALS FOR BALANCE,
CONTROL & MOVEMENT**

FEATURING: THE 4 MAIN FOOTWORK BASES

Introduction

Hey! This is Rainers. I appreciate you tapping in.

Regardless if you're a beginner or a pro:

This book gives you precise, highest level footwork instruction through clear and measurable drills: from stance mechanics to punch-specific timing. You'll build control using the four footwork bases and finish with a solo practice system in **The Boxing Foundations** that turns every session into progress you can track (and feel).

Table of Contents

Chapter 1 The Stance: Athletic Base Mechanics

Chapter 2 The Four Pillars: Steps, Gallops, Pivot, Pendulum

Chapter 3 Jab & Rear Cross Footwork Timing

Chapter 4 Solo Mastery: Film, Stick, Layer, Improve

Created with Inkfluence AI — AI-powered ebook generator

The Stance: Athletic Base Mechanics

Learn the Stance

Set your starting width with one clear rule: **feet at least shoulder-width apart**. When you stand at your stance width, you should feel stable side-to-side without locking your knees.

You should also feel like you can take a step and land under yourself without your weight falling forward or collapsing inward.

Now test it quickly: stand in your stance width, practice a short step forward. You want your body to travel as a unit while your base stays under you. If your front foot lands too close or you lose your footing - widen slightly until your knees track where your feet point. If you feel stuck and stiff, narrow slightly until you can spring without wasting kinetic energy.

Your stance width should support quick recovery.

Golden Rule check: every time you move - forward, backward, left, or right - your feet must originate from the same width and the same posture. Your stance width also becomes your distance anchor and without that anchor, your footwork rhythm breaks down (this makes you a stationary target).

Takeaway: Pick a stance width (feet at least shoulder-width apart), then hold it until it feels stable.

Weight Distribution

Build your base with **weight distributed evenly across both legs**. That means neither heel nor toe should feel like the only “handle” your body relies on. You should feel grounded under both legs so you can push off either direction without stumbling or overreaching.

Use a simple check: bounce in place and check where your balance is. If you feel like you’re tipping forward or leaning back, your distribution is not even. Fix this before you add any movement.

Next: add the spring. **Knees slightly bent to maintain a spring-loaded balance.**

Bent knees keep your system elastic, so you can absorb contact and re-center faster.

Straight knees make you rigid. Rigid legs force your upper body to “catch up,” and that throws off your alignment and timing.

Practical rule: if your stance feels like you could hold it while someone bumps you lightly

from the side, your weight distribution and knee flexion work. If you feel like you have to brace, your distribution is off or your knees aren't spring-loaded.

Takeaway: Lock even weight across both legs, keep knees slightly bent, and stop moving until your base feels loaded and ready.

Lead/rear Alignment That Every Elite Movement Starts from

Building up from the width and weight of your stance - the next point is your lead leg and rear leg relative to your hands.

In stance **y our lead leg matches the lead hand, rear leg corresponds to the rear hand, anchoring the base.**

If you fight orthodox (left hand lead), your lead leg should line up under your left-side posture.

If you fight southpaw (right hand lead), reverse it.

This alignment makes your hips and shoulders easier to organize when you step, pivot, et cetera.

Now lock the posture and keep your stance position consistent.

The Golden Rule matters here too: every step-forward, backward, left, or right must begin with and maintain this foundational position.

Quick alignment check: stand in your stance, then lift your gaze to where you'd typically watch your opponent. Your hips should feel square enough to move without twisting your spine. Your lead knee should track the same direction your lead foot points. If your lead foot turns out too far, your knee won't track clean. If your lead foot points inward, your knee collapses. Adjust the foot until your knee and toes align naturally.

Takeaway: Match lead leg to lead hand and rear leg to rear hand so your base anchors every step. Alignment first, movement second.

Build it like this every rep you start:

- Set **feet at least shoulder-width apart**
- Keep **weight distributed evenly across both legs**
- Bend **knees slightly** for **spring-loaded balance**
- Match **lead leg** with **lead hand**, and **rear leg** with **rear hand**, so the rear leg **anchors the base**

Now do the most important training detail:**film yourself from the side and from a slight angle.** Watch whether your stance changes during movement. You don't need to narrate mistakes. Just observe the mechanical tells: stance width changing, weight loading to left or right leg, knees locking under stress, foot turning the knee off line. When you catch it visual-

ly, you can fix it immediately - because you can see what you can't feel.

Frictionless goal: your stance should feel repeatable even when you speed up. If you rush and your stance falls apart, you built a pose (not a stance).

THE FOUR PILLARS OF MOVEMENT (Where the Stance Fits)

Your stance controls the first movement decision your body makes. Without it, Steps, Gallops, Pivot, and Pendulum all feel like separate skills instead of one connected system. With it, everything connects into place because your base gives your legs a clean platform to work from.

Keep your stance quality high even when you feel tired.

Tired boxers often straighten their knees, shift weight, and rotate their feet to escape discomfort.

You reset and keep your base under you.

The stance gives you control. The movement systems give you options. Next, you'll build the actual movement structures - so you can your base centered.

ENTER THE LOOP

You now possess the mechanical foundation: the **Golden Base Setup**- your exact stance width, even weight distribution, spring-loaded flexion, and lead/rear alignment that every elite movement starts from. Knowing it isn't enough. You need it hardwired, repeated, and drilled until your body uses it automatically when boxing.

The Four Pillars: Steps, Gallops, Pivot, Pendulum

When the pace spikes in the ring, your balance is the first thing that breaks. When your balance breaks, you lose control and you become a target. The fix isn't "trying harder." It's building a repeatable system built into your footwork.

The rule for the 4-Pillar Movement Loop is simple: you move, you recover, and you stay loaded (to attack & defend).

Pick one pillar, execute it with control, and finish by landing back in your exact stance without crossing your feet.

If you finish the move sloppy, you waste time on every single rep.

Steps: The Foundation Steps are the absolute foundation of your footwork. If you watch any elite level boxer you'll see that the skill lies in the details of balance, foot distance, and control after every step. When you move, you must land back in your stance with the exact same spacing and the exact same structure.

- **Practical rule:** Move forward, backward, left, or right, but place your feet under you cleanly. Every step ends put you in a position of advantage.

Galloping: Galloping is used to quickly cover distance or shift angles. It is a highly controlled skip. One foot pushes off the canvas (in the direction you are going to), and the other foot follows quickly.

- **Practical rule:** You must stay in your stance. Never cross your feet. If you start to collapse at the ankles or your strides get too long, you are losing the "spring". Keep it spring-loaded.

Pivoting: Pivoting helps you dictate/create new angles against your opponent. To pivot - take a small step in the direction you want to pivot, stay on the balls of your feet, and twist 45-180 degrees.

- **Practical rule:** Pivoting is not about speed. If your pivot looks like a quick shuffle, you will end up pivoting into a power punch. Turn enough to change the angle, and keep your base strictly under you.

Pendulum Step: The pendulum step is a continuous forward-backward bounce. You push off your rear foot to land on your lead foot, then quickly push off the lead to bounce back repeatedly.

- **Practical rule:** You carry inertia, but you don't slam on the floor. Keep the bounce continuous, land softly, and let the bounce return you to a stance you can actually fire from (use the momentum).

The Recovery Rule & Controlled Rhythm After any pillar action, you must land back into your stance with your balance completely intact. Your recovery is not something that happens "eventually", it is a hard finish. You end the move loaded so you can fire, block, or move again without wasting time on having to reset your body.

Start with a simple idea that: slow motion is better than no motion.

You must feel the moment when your foot transfers the weight, and when you return to stance.

Chase timing and posture in the perfect repetition.

Make your movement look the exact same from rep to rep.

Once you've put in the rounds, you earn the right to speed up.

Takeaway: Pick one pillar and rep it until your recovery lands look identical every single time.

Add the next pillar only after your feet finish clean, balanced, and ready instead of rushing.

Jab & Rear Cross Footwork Timing

The Centerline: Jab & Rear Cross

1 - Jab

Extend your lead hand straight forward and retract straight back to disrupt rhythm.

2 - Rear Cross

Twist your hips and shoulders to launch your rear hand straight down the center-line.

“

***The Golden Rule of This Chapter:** Every jab with a step-forward and every rear cross step-through must start with centerline control and finish with you still balanced enough to throw the next punch without resetting.*

Ask yourself right now: when you jab, do you feel your lead foot land and set your hips before the hand leaves? Or do you throw the jab first and let your feet scramble after?

Jab Steps and Rear Cross Steps Together

The rule-set for matching foot timing to punch timing so the jab disrupts rhythm and the rear cross fires straight down the centerline.

You'll use the same two mechanics every rep:

Your **jab** starts from the lead side and rides a small step-forward. Your **rear cross** starts from the rear side and rides a step-through that sends power down the centerline.

Here's how you feel it when it's right:

- The jab hand fires as the lead foot finishes its landing.
- The rear cross fires as your hips and shoulders rotate while your front foot and weight placement finish the step-through.
- Your torso stays stacked - no leaning off-line, no late "catch-up."

If you want one simple check: after your rear cross, you should still feel your head and chest roughly facing where you attacked. If you finish turned too far, you lost the centerline on the way out.

Takeaway check: Throw five jab-crosses at half speed and watch your own balance. If you can't stop cleanly after the cross without wobbling or stepping back to reset, your timing still needs work.

Jab Timing: Step-Forward Footwork

A jab is not a "reach." You throw it directly from the lead hand to disrupt rhythm and gauge distance. But the jab only gauges distance if your feet keep you on the same track.

Start with the footwork you can repeat without guessing.

When you fire the jab, you execute a **controlled step-forward** that lands your lead foot under you without crossing your feet. Your rear foot stays loaded and ready. You don't surge your weight so far forward that you lose the ability to pivot or retreat.

The Jab Timing Drill:

As you count "one," you step-forward with the lead foot. As you finish that landing, you fire the jab from the lead hand. Stay spring-loaded in your knees - don't lock your legs.

You're training this exact sequence:

1. Lead foot lands
2. Lead hand fires
3. Your upper body stays aligned to the centerline
4. Your rear stays ready to drive the cross

If your hand leaves before your lead foot lands, your jab will land short or off-angle. If your foot lands before your hand fires, your jab becomes a pause - Mina will read that rhythm every time.

Ask yourself: When your jab lands, do you feel like you "arrive" first or "swing" first?

Quick rule: Keep your feet **never crossed**. If you cross, your balance shifts and your center-line shifts with it. That's where timing leaks start.

Takeaway: When your jab timing works, you can throw the next jab without changing your stance shape.

Rear Cross: Step-Through Footwork That Drives Straight Down the Centerline

The rear cross is your power weapon. You launch it by twisting the hips and shoulders

straight down the centerline. That twist only turns into power if your foot timing lets your hips rotate without falling out of position.

So you time the cross around your **step-through**.

As you rotate, your lead foot and weight placement should support the turn, not fight it. Your rear foot pushes and your body travels forward just enough to land the punch with force - not enough to overcommit.

Here's the common failure Mina catches: fighters "throw the cross late" because they waited for the hips to feel ready. The hips never feel ready - you create readiness with your foot timing.

The Rear Cross Timing Drill: Push, Rotate, Step, Punch

You'll use a simple cadence so your brain stops improvising.

- Start loaded like you're about to bounce.
- As you drive the cross, push off the rear to help you move into the step-through.
- Land the cross with your hips and shoulders rotating through the centerline.
- Finish with your balance intact so you can pivot or return to stance without scrambling.

Don't chase speed here. Slow motion better than no motion - when you get the sequencing right, speed becomes a side effect, not the goal.

Takeaway: After the rear cross, you should be able to throw a follow-up jab without resetting your feet.

Jab-Then-Cross Without Delay

Now you connect both punches into one rhythm: jab to disrupt, cross to punish down the line.

The Centerline Synchronizer matters most when a partner changes tempo - because that's when your timing mistakes get exposed. If your jab step is late, your jab will arrive as a "set-up reach." If your rear cross step-through is late, your cross becomes a spin or a swing.

So you build a combo that forces timing.

The 2-Beat Combo: Jab on Beat 1, Rear Cross on Beat 2

Pick a pace you can control. Then lock the sequence:

- Beat 1: step-forward + jab from the lead hand

- Beat 2: step-through + rear cross down the centerline

If you fall off-line, fix the foot timing first. Shoulders follow hips; hips follow feet.

Mini comprehension check: After your jab, do your feet move you forward again before the cross - or do they reset and then you throw? The first one stays synced. The second one creates delay.

Common Timing Errors: Crossing Feet, Late Hands, and Off-Center Finishes

“

***Pro Tip Box:** If you can't throw the jab-cross and stop in control, you're not fundamentally sound. Slow down until you can stop.*

Takeaway: Pick one error and correct it for a full round. Don't fix everything at once. The body learns over time.

Solo Mastery: Film, Stick, Layer, Improve

The Solo Mastery Ladder: Film, Stick, Layer, Improve

That moment when your feet feel “right” in the ring and then you film yourself, watch the video later and realize you’re crossing your feet or falling out of stance - yeah. That’s the fundamental boxing gap most boxers never fully close. Caleb, 28, trained hard for years, showed up on time, and kept his footwork “quick”... until he filmed himself from third-person. You can’t argue with the footage.

Solo mastery is how you close that gap on purpose. You don’t hope you’re doing good and you don’t rely on your coaches judgement.

You build muscle memory with objective visual awareness, then you lock it in through a simple ladder: film, stick, layer, improve. Keep it strict. Slow motion beats rushing every time here.

Set Up Third-Person Film So You Catch Mistakes

You need one camera angle that makes footwork visible.

Caleb fixed his solo sessions fast once he stopped filming like highlight reels and started filming like a mechanic inspecting a bike.

He used the same setup every time so the progression was clear.

Use this setup in your next training session:

- Position the camera to the side and slightly behind your lead shoulder so the whole lead foot and rear foot stay visible.
- Keep the frame steady and level.
- Film long enough to catch your actual movement, not just your first perfect repetition. Start recording before you begin and stop after you finish the rounds.
- Use slow motion playback after. Don’t always review at full speed. Review at the speed where you clearly understand what’s going on.

Ask yourself one question while you watch: *Do my steps keep my feet from crossing and do I land back with balance?*

Practical takeaway: Film from third-person every session and watch slow motion first. You can’t fix what you can’t see clearly.

Stick to One Thing Until Your Feet Stop Lying

Most people try to “work on everything” at once and that’s how they end up with fast feet and sloppy positioning. The solo mastery forces you to narrow the focus until a movement pattern stops changing every repetition.

Pick a single target you can measure visually - something your eyes can catch on video.

Great targets look like this:

- Your lead foot lands in the same spot relative to your body every time.
- Your pivot turns without your feet crossing.
- Your pendulum bounce stays continuous without collapsing momentum.

“

***The Solo Mastery Rule:** Stick to one thing. Layer it when you get better. Improve every session.*

Don’t add a second focus because you’re bored or because you “think you’re close.” Your feet need consistency before you layer.

Practical takeaway: Choose one visible footwork target and train only that until your slow-motion film stops repeating the same error.

The Solo Mastery Ladder: Layer Your Movement Without Breaking Your Base

Once the one thing improves, you layer. Layering means you add a new layer of movement or awareness without changing the base you just built.

Start with how you layer awareness, not just foot patterns. Video tells you what your body forgets under fatigue: dropped hands, lazy steps, and foot placement that drifts even when you “feel balanced.”

Your layering order stays simple:

- Layer the awareness first: watch for the same mistake you already corrected and confirm it stays corrected.
- Then layer the timing: repeat your sequence with the same foot rhythm while you add the next movement detail.
- Then lock the recovery: end every rep by returning to a stable stance with your balance intact.

ENTER THE LOOP: Unlock the Footwork Blueprint

You now possess the framework to move like an elite fighter. But knowing the framework and hardwiring it into your subconscious are two different things. If you are ready to completely rewrite your fight IQ and build flawless muscle memory, you need the complete system.

The full Footwork Blueprint upgrades your training with advanced defensive strategies and **56 strictly programmed rounds of drills.**

UNLOCK THE FOOTWORK BLUEPRINT NOW

Keep winning.

- Rainers

Final Thoughts

By the end of this book, your movement will become clearer and work better: you will move with intent, recover without reaching, and keep your stance stable under pressure. One specific technique to anchor the change is the *Steps* from the four pillars - use it to create angles while keeping your base under you.

Your first action: today, set a 3-minute timer and stay in your stance while building rhythm, adding movement if you feel like it. Do this for 7 days, layer, review your results using the solo process in **The Boxing Foundations** to lock in the progres.